

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

What are the steps involved in networking?



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe jobs and careers in both work and social contexts appropriate for the interlocutor.

Ask your partner:

- Do you have a job? How did you get your current job?
- What are some of the things you do when looking for a job?

Can Do Statements

- I can give descriptions about professional information.
- I can talk about information related to work.
- I can explain how the networking process works.

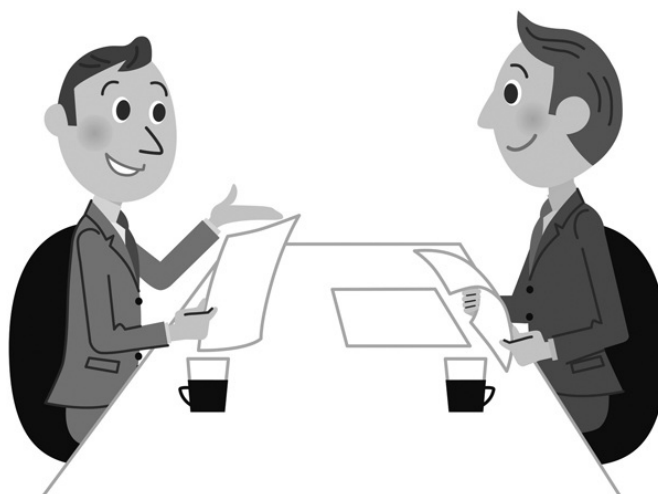




Let's Explore!

Kristi reads an article about how to **conduct*** an informational interview.

* To "conduct" means to carry out a particular activity.



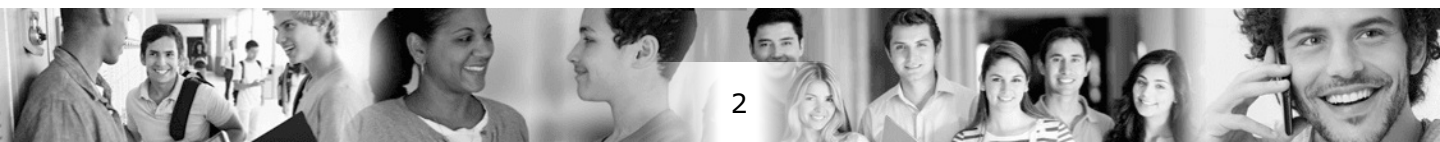
Instructions: Read the text aloud.

In the business world, not all interviews are job interviews. While the word "interview" usually represents a formal meeting organized to help an employer assess the quality of candidates for a particular job, it could equally be arranged for different purposes. An example is the informational interview.

An informational interview is usually initiated by a person who would like to connect with someone who has firsthand experience working in a certain area. They may want to know about future prospects or challenges in the field. The immediate goal is not to obtain a job, but rather to network with people who are working in a given field. A person who initiates an informational interview probably has an interest in working in the field, or may see the potential for collaborating at some point in the future. In either case, an honest discussion about information related to the business can be very useful.

It is common to invite someone you know already to an informational interview, like a former teacher or colleague. It is important to treat the informational interview as a formal meeting. You should follow the same social norms as any interview, including wearing formal attire and arriving 15 minutes early. After preparing specific questions, you should let the conversation flow in a direction that appears useful and interesting to both participants. Prepared questions should not dictate the whole meeting. By wrapping up the meeting after about 30 minutes, you show your respect for your contact.

At the end of the interview, it is acceptable to ask for the contact information of other people who would be willing to meet you. Networking is a continual process of growth that is important for everyone in business. Always thank the person by sending a letter or e-mail as a follow-up.





Let's Practice!

What are some of the tips about informational interviews that Kristi reads?

Instructions: Unscramble the words to find the mystery sentence.

1. way / gain / industry / . / certain / information / working / a / firsthand / to / a / about / It's

2. a / . / is / gaining / not / way / It / of / employment

3. If / of / professors / interested / you're / could / you / your / . / in / teaching / talk / one / to

4. interview / be / professional / and / polite / requesting / Always / . / in / an

5. and / yourself / by / introducing / the / you / . / interview / up / set / why / Start / it



Let's Practice!

What does Kristi read about?

Instructions: Choose the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

1. jobs / targeted résumés / informational interviews
2. firsthand / secondhand / thirdhand
3. mission / strategy / goal
4. discussion / meeting / exchange
5. discuss / dictate / connect
6. important information / detailed information / contact information
7. connecting down / connect around / connecting with others
8. follow in / follow up / follow out

Kristi reads about _____. They are a way to gain _____ information about working in a certain industry and considered a networking _____. An informational interview gives you a chance to have a _____ about the industry, the challenges associated with it, networking secrets, and other topics you may have wanted to know about. The questions will _____ with the flow of conversation. When asking for the _____ of other people, it is important to ask if you may use their name when _____. Always _____ with a thank you letter or e-mail.





Extension Activity

Prepare a presentation.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go on the Internet. Do some research about networking and the process someone should follow.
- Take notes while doing research.
- Using your notes, prepare a short presentation about the networking process.
- Remember to use gerunds.
- Show your presentation to the class.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I identify and do research about networking.

☐ ☐

I use my research to prepare a presentation.

☐ ☐

I use gerunds to explain the networking process.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- informational interview** (noun): a meeting held between two people to learn more about a job or career area
e.g. An informational interview is initiated by a person who would like to connect with someone in the field.
- firsthand** (adjective): gained or obtained from personal experience
e.g. It is an opportunity to meet someone who has firsthand experience working in a certain area.
- discussion** (noun): a detailed conversation
e.g. An honest discussion about information related to the business can be very useful.
- connect with** (expression): establish a relationship with a person
e.g. It is an opportunity to connect with someone working in the field.
- follow-up** (noun): an action that reinforces or confirms a previous action
e.g. Always thank the person by sending a letter or e-mail afterwards as a follow-up.
- to dictate** (verb): to influence; to determine
e.g. Prepared questions should not dictate the whole meeting.





Learning Points

Gerunds

You can use **gerunds** as the subject, the complement or the object of your sentence. Gerunds can also be the object of the preposition in your sentence. For example: *Start **by** giving them a call.*

Preposition	Example
about	<i>I am thinking about attending the training workshop.</i>
after	<i>After sending them a thank you letter, I'll give them a call.</i>
before	<i>Before you start the training, have all documents handy.</i>
by	<i>You can help them by writing the minutes of the meeting.</i>
in	<i>I am interested in working on their website.</i>
of	<i>This is a way of making the team feel welcome.</i>

Networking Etiquette and Tips

Networking is the practice of meeting other people involved in the same kind of work, to share information, support each other etc. Before you start networking, you should assess your interests and skills and a field you want to investigate. Then, you identify potential professionals to contact. Here are some tips to help you:

- Identify the people you would like to speak with. Often, they are people you have had some contact with, like a former colleague or teacher.
- Treat the interview as a serious occasion. Dress appropriately and arrive 15 minutes early.
- Very busy people may prefer to have a phone interview. Be flexible in scheduling.
- If you do not hear back from the person, wait at least one week before contacting them again.
- Remember to follow up with a thank you message.

